Data Office - Statement of Work - 2026

Uni IT – Strategy, Architecture, Data

December 2025

Executive Summary

Purpose & Scope

- Foundational Data Governance: Establish governance frameworks and operating models for a robust data ecosystem over 18 months.
- Security and Compliance Controls: Implement metadata management, security, and compliance to ensure a secure and compliant data environment.
- AI Enablement and Training: Enable AI capabilities and provide training and change management to support advanced analytics use cases.
- Future-State Capabilities: Lay groundwork for federated analytics, semantic layers, automated governance, and measurable business value.

Work Needed Summary

- Major Streams Overview: The SoW includes streams like Governance, Platform Architecture, AI Enablement, and Training, each focusing on core project areas.
- Governance & Strategy Focus: This stream develops Data Management Strategy, Governance Framework, and policies aligned to Information Governance.
- Platform Architecture & Migration: Designs unified data platform using medallion patterns, MortarCAPS standards, and enables observability and FinOps tagging.
- AI Enablement & Training: Delivers AI Operating Model, pipelines, use case registry, pilots, and ensures AI awareness and tool-agnostic training.

Cost Breakdown

- Overall Budget Range: The 18-month ROM budget is estimated between **AUD $10.55M and $17.35M**, covering all project expenses.
- Major Cost Categories: Key expenditure includes People, Platform & Data Tooling, Security & Compliance, Storage & Compute, AI Enablement, and Training.
- Quarterly Spending Pattern: Quarterly spend varies from $1.45M to $3.2M, with peaks in Q1 and Q4 for setup and pilot execution phases.
- Variance Drivers: Budget variance is driven by staffing mix, tooling choices, security posture, AI pilot scope, and storage growth.

Overview

Data is at the heart of everything we do and a core foundation to enabling the success of UWA.

The concern around needing good data and good data practices has come from multiple angles:

- Internal Audit (draft): data governance and quality recommendations
- IT Risks: trust in data and AI readiness risks and controls
- Strategic Risk: data governance risk and controls
- UWA 2030 strategy (draft): improve data governance & quality; simplify & automate processes
- IT & Data Strategy (draft): unified data intelligence and governance
- IA Strategy (draft): modernise the data landscape
- Data Operations Model: recommendations, proposed operational model and roadmap with work packages.

This Statement of Work (SoW) provides a high-level plan based on these key documents to identify the work needed to establish the Data Office, resources and ROM costings for 2026/7.

Combined Priorities

1. A university-wide data & AI operating model, governance framework, governance forum and issues/risk register
2. Data & AI roles, accountabilities and responsibilities with training and agreed processes
3. Standards, guidelines for data & AI quality, integrity and reliability
4. Unified data & AI platform with a data fabric, governance tools, automation, self-serve
5. Data Hub for centralising data practices, architecture, engineering and guiding data spokes for autonomy.

Priorities from Audit & Risk

The draft Internal Audit for **Data Governance (Focus on Data Quality)** due to be completed by end of December 2025 was to review data governance and data quality across student and staff data.

- Evaluating whether data governance frameworks, policies, and standards are in place, comprehensive, and aligned with University strategy and legislative obligations.
- Assessing the implementation of roles and responsibilities for data owners, stewards, custodians, and business owners in overseeing data quality.
- Reviewing data quality management processes, including profiling, validation, cleansing, and monitoring activities within student and staff data systems.
- Assessing integration, lineage, and escalation mechanisms between key systems to ensure traceability and accuracy of data flows across both student and staff data domains.
- Student data systems: Callista, UWA Apply, Syllabus Plus, CAS, and the Enterprise Data Warehouse (EDW / Data Lake).
- Staff data systems: PageUp, ServiceNow, and Ascender (aPay).
- Examining the application of data retention, protection, and privacy controls in line with the University's Information Governance Framework and related policies.

There are 4 findings, 18 recommendations, 1 major risk and 3 moderate risks.

Priorities

1. A university-wide data operating model, governance framework and performance metrics
2. Data Stewards are assigned roles, responsibilities and accountabilities with training and guidance
3. Student data quality and historical data are consistently assured across systems, the data platform and analytics
4. Centralised and automated record management processes.

Priorities from Audit & Risk

REF	Recommendation	Gap	What's Needed/Action
R1	• Enterprise-wide accountability • Setting and maintaining data governance strategy and/or framework • Define data quality policy and standards • Ensuring appropriate resourcing & capability • Oversee data quality reporting & risks	• No framework • No standards • No resources • No reporting	• Develop data Governance Framework – Feb to Jul 2026 • Develop policies and standards – Q1 2026 • Data management and governance resources to develop artefacts • Establish a Data Governance Committee with Charter and ToR
R2	• Set up a data governance structure • Set up a data operational model • Set of a data CoE • Define and maintain the stewardship model	• No framework • No data operating model (have phase 1 use case) • No CoE • No resources	• Develop data Governance Framework – Feb to Jul 2026 • Phase 2 Data Operational Model (uni-wide) – Feb – June 2026 • Data Working Group – firm up intention (ToR) and activities • Establish a Data Governance Committee with Charter and ToR • Data management and governance resources to develop artefacts
R3	• Publish a Data Quality Standard • Ensure data quality practices remain consistent and continuously improved • Prioritise Critical Data Elements • Create data issues, risk register, assessments	• No standards • No resources to monitor quality • No CDE register • No issues, risk register	• Develop policies and standards – Q1 2026 • Phase 2 Data Operational Model (uni-wide) – Feb – June 2026 • Data quality management resources to develop, maintain and support • Develop a CDE register • Develop an issues and risk register • Develop data quality assessments
R4	• Publish CDE in a catalogue • Create a lineage map for staff and student IDs • Develop approval workflow	• No CDE catalogue • No lineage map • No approval workflows or tools	• Develop policies and standards – Q1 2026 • Phase 2 Data Operational Model (uni-wide) – Feb – June 2026 • Develop CDE catalogue and publishing tool • Develop lineage maps and tools for accessibility • Develop approval workflows for changes and orchestration for automation • Resources to develop, implement, maintain and support
R5	• Provide periodic data quality reports • Report to Executive forum • Prioritise investments • Track progress against objectives	• Limited quality reporting • No data forum • No tracking • No resources for tracking tool	• Data Quality Performance Reports to be developed in Q2 2026 delivered end of 2026 • Data Governance Framework commences Feb 2026, end July 2026 • Data Governance Committee to commence in Q1 2026 • Tracking tool/ dashboard to report progress • Resources to develop, implement, maintain and support

Major Risk

Priorities from Audit & Risk

REF	Recommendation	Gap	What's Needed/Action
R6	• Undertake a data quality risk assessment • Apply the UWA risk framework	• Partial DQ risk assessment (see IT Audit and Risk)	• DQ Risk Assessment commence June 2026, end Dec 2026 • Data Governance Framework commences Feb 2026, end July 2026 • Phase 2 Data Operating Model to commence in Feb 2026, end June 2026
R7	• Embed Data Steward responsibilities into role descriptions	• No roles and responsibilities defined • No resources to develop	• Data Governance Framework commences Feb 2026, end July 2026 • Phase 2 Data Operating Model to commence in Feb 2026, end June 2026 • Resources to develop, implement, maintain and support
R8	• Update RACI for data roles	• No roles and responsibilities defined • No resources to develop	• Data Governance Framework commences Feb 2026, end July 2026 • Phase 2 Data Operating Model to commence in Feb 2026, end June 2026 • Resources to develop, implement, maintain and support
R9	• Develop a structured training program for Stewards, focusing on CDEs	• No training program • No trainers • No investment for training	• Data Quality Training Program - Statement of Work to commence Q3 2025, end June 2027 • Training resources to develop program & content, monitor and support
R10	• Introduce KPIs across data domains for performance measures • Align to the Data Quality Standard	• No KPIs • No DQ standard • No resources	• Develop policies and standards – Q1 2026 • Data Governance Framework commences Feb 2026, end July 2026 • Resources to develop KPIs, implement, maintain and support
R11	• Embed duplicate record prevention controls to manual data collection points	• No controls • No resources	• Conduct data collection review for student data entry • Resources to develop, implement, maintain and support
R12	• Ensure EDW tables reference versioned dimension records for history	• Issues in some reports	• Conduct review for issues • Develop business requirements • Service request to fix
R13	• Ensure modifications or upgrades with student data take into consideration impacts • Alignment to MotarCaps data model	• No clear processes for paths of change/ solution design • MotarCaps not released yet	• MotarCAPS standard due to be adopted in first half of 2026 • Solution design process review January 2026 • Service design process commence January 2026, end Jun 2026 • IT Delivery Framework commence Q1 2026, end Sep 2026

Major Risk **Moderate Risk**

Priorities from Audit & Risk

REF	Recommendation	Gap	What's Needed/Action
R14	• Use SoT for executive dashboarding • Document lineage • Develop a roadmap to migrate to lakehouse	• All data for exec reporting is not in the lakehouse • No roadmap • No resources to migrate	• Lakehouse Migration Plan/ SoW commence January 2026, end Mar 2026 • Develop roadmap for executive dashboards • Resources to develop, implement, maintain and support
R15	• Standardise data entry with controlled data elements • Automated enforcement of critical identifiers across systems	• No data standard for data entry • No controlled elements • No automation	• Review of systems and controls for data entry to identify systems at risk • Develop policies and standards – Q1 2026 • Identify patterns to enforce critical identifiers • Identify enhancements to existing systems • Implement changes through demand process
R16	• Establish SoT and secure repository for Sensitive and PII • Implement controlled digital capture	• No process • No controlled elements • No automation	• Review repositories for sensitive and PII data • Develop policies and standards – Q1 2026 • Identify patterns to enforce controls • Identify enhancements to existing systems • Implement changes through demand process
R17	• Uplift integration between HR and IT systems • Introduce Master Data Management capability	• No MDM management and governance • No resources to manage	• Plan is in place to replace HR systems to HCM solution • Project to implement a HCM solution, maintain and support • Identify MDM for HCM and implement in project • Resources to develop, implement, maintain and support
R18	• Embed requirements for staff data within R&D Disposal Schedule • Map to business processes • Support with targeted training and assurance • Operationalise DLP • Develop metrics and reports to monitor effectiveness and report on	• No process maps • No training/trainers • No assurance • No uni-wide plan for DLP • No metrics to report • No resources	• Map process for staff data in R&D Schedule • Develop training program • Training resources to develop program & content, monitor and support • Develop assurance process and performance outcomes • Develop report • Provide resources to monitor and report.

Moderate Risk

Priorities from IT Risk

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The **IT systemic risks** from 2024 moving into 2026 include 2 risks related to data:

- Trust in Data (major risk): poor data quality and ineffective data governance may undermine trust in data-driven technology systems and processes, leading to non-delivery of strategy, poor decision making, cost overrun, data breach or legal non-compliance
  - **Disjointed systems and data silos**
  - **Manual data inputs without validation**
  - **Lack of top-down direction and data governance**
  - **Lack of data governance framework**
  - **Re-importing data into PowerBI models instead of certified data sets**
  - **Rapid data growth & increasing reliance on data**
- AI Readiness (moderate risk): ineffective technology enablement of AI adoption hinders UWA's ability to realise the full benefits of AI, including data-driven decision making and operational efficiencies, leading to loss of competitive advantage, cost overrun, data breach or legal non-compliance
  - **Absence of an AI strategy and framework**
  - **Limited in-house expertise in AI/ML**
  - **Data required for AI models is poor quality**
  - **Lack if adequate IT infrastructure (storage)**
  - **AI projects require significant upfront investment**
  - **Internal resistance from teams**
  - **Lack of guidelines for securing AI**
  - **Complex or evolving regulations regarding governance, privacy, ethics.**

There are 2 risk bow-ties to mitigate risks and introduce controls

Priorities

1. Data governance framework (including ownership and responsibilities – **strategic risk**
2. Data management strategy (including data quality strategy)
3. AI Strategy
4. AI Statement of Work (to implement actions from strategy
5. Formal AI governance

Priorities from IT Risk

REF	Controls	Gap	What's Needed/Action
IT-R5	• Develop a data governance framework • Develop data strategy • Develop data quality strategy • Manage stakeholder engagement and expectations	• Strategy in draft • No governance framework • No resources	• Data Management Strategy – Jan 2026 • Data Governance Framework commences Feb 2026, end July 2026 • Resources to develop, implement, maintain and support
IT-R6	• Develop an AI strategy • Develop AI governance framework • Develop Statement of Work	• AI strategy in draft • No governance framework	• AI strategy to be released and actioned • AI Statement of Work approved for funding • Develop program of work to implement

Major Risk   Moderate Risk

Strategic Priorities

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The **UWA Strategy 2026 – 2030 (draft)** has identified data as a key enabler. Enablers build the foundational capabilities and operational agility to deliver on our strategic ambitions

- Action 2: Minimise administrative burden through process, technology and data improvement
  - **Implement the AI, IT & Data Strategy initiatives and actions**
  - **Establish centralised platforms by 2030**
  - **Remove, replace, or migrate legacy technology assets**

Foundational systems, processes, and cultural elements empower our people and enable effective, data-driven decision-making across the university.

Priorities

1. Improve data governance and quality
   - Improve master data, establish platforms and harness insights for decision making
2. Simplify and automate processes
   - Business process streamlining and automation
   - Apply AI and integration to enhance productivity

Strategic Priorities – UWA 2030

REF	Initiative	Gap	What's Needed/Action
A2.1	• Improve master data, establish platforms and harness insights for decision making	• No master data management and governance • No unified platform (have Azure databricks) • Developing insights is limited • Resources for unified platform	• Identification of Master Data for systems • Establish responsibilities for MDM in governance framework • Data Governance Framework commences Feb 2026, end July 2026 • Design the unified data platform • Develop the unified data platform solution • Resources to develop, implement, maintain and support
A2.2	• Apply AI and integration to enhance productivity (refer to AI Strategy)	• AI strategy in draft • No governance framework	• AI strategy to be released and actioned • AI Statement of Work approved for funding • Develop program of work to implement

Strategic Priorities – IT & Data

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The **IT & Data Strategy (draft)** has identified data as a key enabler and foundation for both progressing IT and the rest of UWA. A key opportunity is to establish strong data management practices across the university - to leverage analytics& insights, ML and AI models.

- Enable Data-Driven Decisions: trusted data to drive AI-enabled insights can improve forecasting & early interventions for student success
- Unified Data, Intelligence, & Insights: get the foundations right by providing a trusted, governed unified data ecosystem that enables real-time, predictive analytics, and AI-driven decision-making
- Leveraging Advanced Platforms & AI: utilising advanced platforms, data analytics, and artificial intelligence to drive innovation, efficiency, and resilience
- Combined intelligence: data and AI will power intelligent decision-making and personalised learning across every stage of the student and research lifecycle.

Priorities

Unified Data, Intelligence & Governance

- **Data Platform & DataOps:** secure unified data ecosystem (MDM, metadata/lineage, streaming, API hub), automated discovery/search/publish, governed pipelines.
- **BI/ML & citizen Development:** self-service BI, embedded ML for prediction/anomaly detection, low-code/no-code with guardrails & automated compliance.

Outcomes:

- Trusted insights & predictions
- Data-driven decisions
- Modern compliance & governance.

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Strategic Priorities – IT & Data

REF	Initiative	Gap	What's Needed/Action
T:2	• Unified Data Fabric & Common Data Model • Responsible AI at Scale	• No data fabric • CDM in draft • No AI to scale	• Implement the MortarCAPS common data model • Complete the medallion architecture and data sets in the lakehouse • Pilot/PoC the unified data fabric for a student related use case • Develop AI Operating Model and Governance Framework • Develop early warning & intervention models for Students (Attrition)
T:7	• Unified Data, Intelligence & Insights • Secure Handling of Data & Modern Compliance	• Some classification exists • No synthetic data to test • No encryption at REST • Consent management limited	• Define Critical Data Elements (CDEs) in a register • Apply data classification and access controls for critical datasets. • Develop AI Operating Model and Governance Framework • Introduce synthetic data in non-prod environments. • Implement audit logging and encryption for sensitive data • Develop consent management for securing personal data • Develop a RAG foundation for enterprise search
T:8	• AI-Enabled Research & Supercompute	• No AI-enabled research • Some supercompute • Poor skills • Limited resources to manage	• Model the unified research data environment • Develop and implement the HPC/Supercompute strategy • Develop a resource plan and skills uplift
T:10	• Automation, AI/ML & FinOps	• No automation for data/AI operational activities • Limited ML • No FinOps • Limited resources	• Develop automation and DataSecOps practices to automate parts of the data platform • Ensure data is structured for FinOps reporting • Expand ML capability for prediction and anomaly detection • Develop an observability baseline • Resources to develop, implement, maintain, support
T:11	• Data Platform & DataOps • BI/ML & Citizen Development	• Limited data platform • Ad-hoc data operations • No citizen development • Limited resources	• Develop AI Operating Model and Governance Framework • Develop AI Operating Model and Governance Framework • Develop BI/Citizen development use cases • Embed ML with citizen development • Resources to develop, implement, maintain, support

Strategic Priorities – IT & Data

REF	Initiative	Gap	What's Needed/Action
T:13	• Establish UWA Data/AI Operating Model & Governance • Operationalise a Hub & Spoke Model	• Phase 1 Op Model in draft • No baseline or maturity assessment • No AI Op Model • No resources	• Phase 2 Data Operational Model (uni-wide) – Feb – June 2026 • Data Governance Framework commences Feb 2026, end July 2026 • Develop AI Operating Model and Governance Framework • Develop baseline maturity assessment • Develop data & AI capability plan • Resources to develop, implement, maintain, support
T:14	• Operationalise Feedback Loops & Decision Support • Activate Advanced Analytics & AI	• Feedback is ad-hoc • No decision support tools • Advanced analytics limited • Analytic/predictive tools limited • No support resources	• Develop feedback loop process • Develop decision support processes/tools • Review advanced analytic tools and communicate • Resources to develop, implement, maintain, support
T:15	• Deploy AI Assistants & Agentic Interfaces • Automate DataOps/AIOps	• No created AI assistants • No agentic AI • Pipelines limited • No playbooks • No observability • Limited resources	• Develop AI Operating Model and Governance Framework • Develop AI pipelines • Develop AI playbook • Develop observability processes/tools • Resources to develop, implement, maintain, support
T:16	• Stand-up a Unified Data Mesh and Fabric • Transition to Industrialised Governance	• No data mesh or fabric • CDM in draft • No AI to scale • No interoperability • No industrialised governance	• Complete the medallion architecture and data sets in the lakehouse • Pilot/PoC the unified data mesh/fabric for a student related use case • Implement the MortarCAPS common data model • Define the metadata and interoperability solution • Define industrialised governance

Strategic Priorities – AI

The **AI Strategy (draft)** has identified data as the core building block (cornerstone) to developing AI capability. The "4-D" approach covers Data, Development, Distributed Approaches, and Discovery, supported by 10 Strategic Priorities and 31 Key Actions. The objectives for Theme 1: Data include -

- Develop a comprehensive data governance policy (2026).
- Establish a federated "hub-and-spoke" data management architecture with certified datasets and Data Stewards (2026–2027).
- Implement sector-wide data standards (Mortarcaps, CAUDIT) for interoperability (2027).
- Train staff to use certified datasets and support "citizen data scientists" (2027 onward).
- Invest in central data governance tools for privacy and security (2027).

Priorities

1. Data operational model.
2. AI process improvement prioritisation
3. Trusted production approach for training data
4. AI staff training program
5. Adoption and savings metrics
6. Diverse capabilities for HPC
7. AI Customisation methods
8. AI Self-Service
9. Discovery tool
10. AI-ready education & student experience

Strategic Priorities – AI - Data

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REF	Initiative	Gap	What's Needed/Action
A1	Data governance policy	No data governance	Data & AI Governance Framework with policies, standards
A2	Data operational model and architecture	No Data Engineers to respond to demand once that is known	• University operation model to plan from and Data Standard around certified sets • Data Governance Framework should inform the data ops model • Advanced Lakehouse
A3	MotarCAPS standard for interoperability	MortarCAPs in draft Don't have Data Specialists in each portfolio	• MortarCAPS to be ratified for use • This will be implemented in the Integration Platform, with snapshots of history stored in the Lakehouse for longitudinal reporting. Will need additional resourcing • IT to lead the data standard, provide resources to communicate, train, collaborate, new resources • Semantic model and translation layer made available in a machine-native format (refers to Business Glossary) • Data Specialists in each portfolio to incorporate domain specific expertise
A4	Training program for gold certified datasets	No training program	• Training program, training tools, training content, Trainers • Databricks training for citizen Data Scientists on how to access the Gold Datasets from Unity Catalogue
A5	Central data governance tool	Don't have a centralised governance tool	Unity Catalogue / Purview could feed a uni-wide Data Governance tool such as Informatica/Hummingbird
A6	Low risk self-assessment and automated approval	No process for low risk-assessment	• Require platform for recording AI Use cases to measure successes • Impacts initiative assessment and SD processes - changes third party risk management processes • Extra cyber security tools to automate process

Strategic Priorities – AI - Data

REF	Initiative	Gap	What's Needed/Action
A7	Cyber-approved AI tools, systems and technologies	No AI checklists, DLP for AI, compliance checks	• Integrate AI tools with Purview for data governance and the SOC for threat monitoring. • Apply DLP and encryption for sensitive data • Prepare a Cyber Sanctioning Workflow integrating security and compliance checks. • Draft an AI Governance Checklist for tool onboarding • Educate staff on AI risks (shadow AI, prompt injection, data leakage)
A8	AI-accelerated process improvement	• Poor process mapping • No process mining • No business requirements • No AI pilot process	• Clear processes mapped, working with process improvement • Ability to do process mining to determine effort and efficiencies, hours saved, cost savings • Business requirements analysis and case for change to prove out cost savings • Pilots with reviews and lessons learned – project management?
A9	Local AI deployment strategy	• Can't monitor or control local AI deployments • No co-ordination roles	• Strategy, implementation plan and process • Roles to engage and liaise and co-ordinate use cases and data operations work • Tools to identify local IA deployments
A10	Platform for AI training data	• No environment set up for training data • No vendor assessment process • No chargeback	• Enhance the data platform/s to train models, licencing arrangement • Role-based access • Control over geographic data storage locations • Training dataset management • User cost model • Data transfer from certified sets into training data • Pipelines for training data
A11	Pipelines to generate data for AI training	• No AI pipelines, have data pipelines • No patterns • No use case process	• AI operating model and processes • Pipelines for training data • Patterns for business unit use • Use case analysis
A12	Protocols and system for storing unedited AI data outputs	• No system for separating raw/edited AI data • No process for raw and edited content/data	• Assume IRDS for Research but would require increased storage allocation for non-research related data and processes for storage management • Management and governance process for raw/edited data separation • Solution design and potential project to deliver solution • Operational model and resources to maintain and support

Data Operation Priorities

The **Data Governance & Operating Model Roadmap** by SIA Partners covers the 'ways of working' between teams that have data activities in the way data is produced and consumed.

Given the university's diverse data requirements, the logical next step for the university is to strengthen their central data capability to provide high level oversight and give autonomy to other areas of the business (i.e. 'spokes') to drive their own data needs, therefore a 'Hub and Spoke' Operating Model.

To achieve this model, the roadmap includes:

- Foundations – defining the rules of the operating model
- The Operating Model (Hub and Spoke) – defining roles, structures and interactions between teams
- Enablement – building the capacity to adopt the model.

Priorities

1. Implement data strategy and investment roadmap
2. Endorsing data governance activities, roles and forums
3. Build domain analytics & governance, appoint data stewards
4. Define hub and spoke operating model, accountability & interaction
5. Standardise lifecycle and change control with shared workflows
6. Review and implement tooling
7. Create data quality framework, rules, standards, tooling and management
8. Extend privacy-by-design across domains, standardise access
9. Develop enterprise data literacy, training and uplift culture.

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Strategic Priorities – Data Ops.

REF	Initiative	Gap	What's Needed/Action
WP1	**Data Strategy Review & Development**	• IT & Data Strategy in draft, not endorsed yet • No strategic alignment across investments	• Assess UWA's current data landscape and define a forward-looking roadmap and investment pathway for governance, analytics, AI readiness, and operating model maturity. • Establish alignment with the IT & Data strategy and institutional objectives and identify the foundational capabilities required to support scalable data and AI initiatives
WP2	**Data Governance Framework, Guidelines & Policies**	• No data governance framework • No guidelines and policies	• Develop and formalise the university-wide Data Governance Framework, including roles, responsibilities, standards, definitions, privacy-by-design principles, data quality and lifecycle. Develop or update supporting guidelines and policies to provide clear, consistent governance guardrails across domains.
WP3	**Data Operating Model Design**	• No central 'hub', have a BI team • No processes developed	• Define the target enterprise hub and spoke data operating model, detailing how the central hub, business domains, and governance roles work together. • Establish key processes, responsibilities, and engagement pathways to enable consistent data delivery, governance, and scalable analytics and AI.
WP4	**Define & Establish Data Governance Forums**	• No data governance forums/bodies • Limited escalation paths	• Define and launch the core governance structures required to manage data effectively, such as a Data Governance Board and Standards & Quality Forums. • Set clear mandates, decision rights, meeting rhythms, escalation paths, and alignment to the Information Governance model
WP5	**Critical Data Element Identification**	• Limited critical data identification • Some business data documentation but not communicated	• Identify and prioritise the university's most critical data elements across key domains (e.g., Student, Research, HR, Finance). • Document definitions, business rules, lineage, ownership, quality expectations (aligned with guidelines), and usage patterns to establish authoritative enterprise data and support analytics and AI accuracy
WP6	**Review Data Governance Tools**	• Some data governance tools not communicated • Limited data metadata management	• Evaluate existing tools and repositories (e.g., purview, glossary, definitions catalogues, lineage trackers, metadata stores) for suitability. • Determine gaps and select appropriate technologies to enable metadata management, lineage visibility, data quality monitoring, certification workflows, and scalable governance automation

Strategic Priorities – Data Ops.

REF	Initiative	Gap	What's Needed/Action
WP7	**Data/Analytics Demand Management Uplift**	• Demand process and management not clear • Data service offering not implemented yet	• Improve SPP and BI&A demand management by introducing a single intake process, shared prioritisation criteria, and a visible, jointly-owned backlog, supported by a weekly delivery cadence to review priorities, dependencies, risks and resourcing. • Stabilise data service delivery today, while creating the structure needed to smoothly transition into the future hub-and-spoke operating model.
WP8	**Deploy Data Governance Tools**	• Tools exist but no documentation or communication • No process to support activities	• Address tooling gaps identified in WP6 to enable data governance practices. This includes introducing and/or configuring systems to support metadata & glossary, lineage, data quality and semantic modelling & certification capabilities. • Provide an ongoing activity that will start by supporting data office activities and evolve to support domains as they are onboarded to the new operating model.
WP9	**Establish Data Office/Hub**	• No roles	• Hire or assign the roles required to stand up the Data Office, including architects, engineers and governance roles. • Further define responsibilities, decision rights, and operating rhythms where required
WP10	**Hub Training**	• No trainers or training capability	• Deliver training for all Hub roles on governance standards, modelling practices, workflows, quality rules, and supporting tools to ensure consistent execution across the central team
WP11	**Implement Domain Governance Roles**	• No roles defined	• Activate Steward, Custodian, and business System Owner roles by formalising decision rights, handoffs, and responsibilities
WP12	**Domain Foundations Training**	• No trainers or training capability	• Provide foundational training to domain Stewards, Custodians and System Owners on their responsibilities for data quality, definitions, and governance
WP13	**Embed Data Governance in Operational Workflows**	• No data governance or standards	• Introduce defined governance rules into day-to-day Data Office and Domain workflows. • This includes embedding standards (definitions, quality rules, access, lifecycle, lineage) into data practices like analytics, data engineering, reporting, and data entry. • Ensure governance rules are followed in how models are built, how data is entered and published, how definitions are approved, and how issues are resolved
WP14	**Deploy CDE governance**	• Limited critical data identification • No DQ dashboard	• Roll out targeted CDE data quality monitoring, data dictionary, business glossary, and lineage tools to provide transparency of data health and provenance. • Establish rules, dashboards, and alerts that support proactive quality management and feed into governance forums and stewardship processes

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Strategic Priorities – Data Ops.

REF	Initiative	Gap	What's Needed/Action
WP15	**Review & support EDW Migration Project**		• Review the existing EDW migration program to assess its impacts, risks, and dependencies on the new data operating model, ensuring BAU continuity and understanding implications for current teams and governance structures.
WP16	**Data team re-brand**	• Limited data BI team • No resources for a Data Office	• Introduce the Data Office re-brand through a university-wide change and communications program that explains their roles, how staff should engage with them, and who to contact in their domain for data issues, ensuring all units understand how to operate within the new data ecosystem.
WP17	**Spoke Pilot Identification**	• No agreed data domains • No resource to align with spoke	• Prioritise business domains for onboarding into the hub-and-spoke model based on data maturity, strategic value, and readiness to adopt shared standards. • SPP and Load Planning are the natural first spokes, as they already operate closely with the Hub to deliver enterprise insights. • This initiative will focus on formalising their roles, responsibilities, and alignment to the operating model before expanding to other domains.
WP18	**Detail Spoke Operating Model**	• No resources for a Data Office • No roles and responsibilities	• Apply the enterprise hub-and-spoke operating model to the selected pilot domain by designing its detailed day-to-day interactions with the Data Office (Hub). • Establish clear hand-offs between stewards, custodians, analysts and Hub governance roles. • Use early interactions to test, refine, and streamline the operating model so that it becomes a repeatable, scalable pattern for future spokes.
WP19	**Spoke Data Capability Uplift**	• No resources for a Data Office	• Assess the pilot spoke's readiness (i.e. skills) and existing analytics demand / priorities. • Identify key skills/roles needed to successfully operate within the hub-and-spoke model (e.g. local analysts or engineers, modelling training, etc). • Roll out the required uplift activities to ensure the spoke has the skills, support, and capacity to function effectively during the pilot.
WP20	**Configure Spoke Tooling**	• No resources for a Data Office	• Set up the pilot spoke's technical environment so it can work effectively within the hub-and-spoke model. • This includes configuring its workspace, access and security roles, lineage and data quality views, and the use of certified semantic models. Align with enterprise standards

Strategic Priorities – Data Ops.

REF	Initiative	Gap	What's Needed/Action
WP21	**Spoke Data Literacy Uplift**	• No resources for a Data Office • No trainers or training	• Deliver communications that clarify the hub-and-spoke model, including roles, responsibilities and how the spokes engage with the hub. • Strengthen data literacy across domains and promote clear, simple risk mechanisms
WP22	**Spoke Roll-out**	• No resources for a Data Office	• Roll-out the pilot spoke by putting the designed ways of working into practice. • Observe how these behaviours work in practice, identify where adjustments are needed, and refine the operating model based on what is learned.
WP23	**Scale Hub-and-Spoke to Additional Domains**	• No resources for a Data Office • No trainers or training	• Identify where shadow analytics currently exist and which areas have the strongest data needs, then roll out the refined hub-and-spoke model to new domains in priority order. • Tailor the model to each domain's maturity and provide targeted training in modelling, governance and data literacy to support successful adoption.
WP24	**Future Architecture Requirements**	• No architects or architecture for platform	• Design a future-state platform architecture that enables federated, Fabric-style domain workspaces while maintaining enterprise guardrails and governance. • Incorporate lessons and integrations from existing pilots, and define the uplift steps, security controls, integration patterns, and participation rules required for domains to operate
WP25	**Automate Governance, Quality, and Lineage Controls**	• Limited automation	• Introduce automated data governance practices, including data quality checks, lineage capture, metadata harvesting, access controls, and exception workflows.
WP26	**Enterprise Semantic Layer & Modelling Standards**	• Limited semantic models • No KPIs • No self-service	• Develop a shared semantic layer that provides centrally governed, reusable business definitions and metrics that can be consumed by all domains and tools. • Creates a single source of truth for KPIs, reduces duplicated modelling effort in spokes, and prevents inconsistent logic across reports. • Enable scalable self-service, supports automation, and becomes a key building block for federated analytics
WP27	**Domain Data Community**	• Working group just established • Domains not established	• Establish a community of practice for domain analysts, stewards and custodians to share patterns, learnings and improvement ideas. • Define clear role expectations, progression levels and learning pathways to make data roles attractive and build capability across domains. • Use this community to reinforce behaviours, uplift skills and continuously refine the hub-and-spoke model as it scales

Scope of Work

THE UNIVERSITY OF WESTERN AUSTRALIA

Scope of Work for IT – 2026/7

Purpose:

Establish university-wide data & AI management, operation and governance practices. The program delivers foundational building blocks, guardrails and scalable capabilities across teaching, research, and operations.

Objectives for Uni IT:

- Data Governance and Strategy - implement a Data Governance Framework with standards, policies.
- Data Operating Model - develop supporting playbooks to guide change
- Demand & Delivery – develop demand and delivery processes for data
- Operations & Support – maintenance, monitoring and support processes/tools
- Data Security – implement controls to prevent data loss and vulnerabilities
- Data Platform & FinOps - establish pilot/PoC data mesh/fabric to prove out unified data platform and cost modelling
- Analytics – using semantic models for sharing and ML/AI capability
- AI Strategy & AI Operating Model - implement a Data Governance Framework with standards, policies and operating model
- Training & Education – developing a training program and educational/ awareness areas
- Community & Capability – developing the working group to uplift capabilities
- Research Data – modelling the research data landscape and target state.

Future State Intentions

Unified Data Infrastructure:
Implementing unified data fabric and mesh to enable seamless data integration and governance across platforms.

Responsible AI and Automation:
Scaling responsible AI with automation and deploying AI assistants to enhance decision support and operations.

Advanced Analytics and Insights:
Activating advanced analytics, BI/ML, and AI-enabled research to derive actionable intelligence and insights.

Governance and Compliance:
Establishing data operating models, secure handling of data, compliance, and industrialised governance frameworks.

In-Scope Streams (2026/7)

ID	Stream	Work Package	Acceptance Criteria
G1	Governance & Strategy	Data Management Strategy & roadmap aligned to institutional objectives	Strategy approved; 5 year roadmap with investment, dependencies, KPIs; quarterly review cadence established.
G2		Data Governance Framework (roles, mandates, lifecycle, data quality) & industrialised governance integrated with DataOps	Framework approved and published; governance forum and cadence; change control active.
G3		Develop policies & standards (Quality, Metadata/Definitions, Access/PII, Lifecycle/Retention, Issue Mangement)	Legal/IG review complete; version-controlled repository; standard templates for KPIs, CDEs, quality rules; adoption evidenced in ≥2 domains.
G4		Data Governance Committee (Charter/ToR) & Data Working Group (ToR/activities)	Charters approved; membership set; monthly committee & bi-weekly working group operating
RAW 1		Management & governance for raw/edited data separation & lifecycle	Policies enforced via platform controls; lineage linking raw→edited→gold; 0 critical audit variances.
OM1	Operating Model	Define enterprise hub-and-spoke Operating Model (roles, RACI, engagement playbook, SLAs/OLAs)	Blueprint approved; playbook published; 2 walk-through simulations completed; SLAs documented.
OM2		University-wide scaling plan; domain prioritisation & onboarding	Prioritisation framework; ≥2 domains scheduled by Month 18;
DM1	Demand & Delivery	IT Delivery Framework; solution design (with data design) and service design process reviews; single intake and prioritisation	Frameworks updated; intake live; weekly cadence; prioritisation rubric; >80% visibility of requests; 15% reduction in unplanned work.
BR1		Standardise business requirements and case for change (benefit & cost evidence)	Templates with traceability to KPIs/CDEs; ≥3 business cases delivered with quantified savings; funded backlog item
KPI1		Tracking dashboard; program KPIs (governance adoption, quality, delivery lead time, semantic usage, training)	Dashboard live; ≥3 KPIs meet targets by Month 12; quarterly review cadence; actions tracked and closed.
OPS1	Operations & Support	Operational model and resources to maintain & support pipelines/platforms (including SOC/Purview integration)	Ops playbook with SLAs; resourcing ≥80% filled; MTTR & reliability KPIs met; quarterly ops reviews completed.

In-Scope Streams (2026/7)

ID	Stream	Work Package	Acceptance Criteria
SEC1	**Data Security**	Apply data classification and role-based access controls (RBAC) to critical datasets	Classification scheme published; RBAC implemented for top-risk datasets; ≥90% high-risk assets have masking; 0 critical audit findings.
SEC2		Consent management capability for personal data	Consent repository/process live; enforced in sharing workflows; legal review passed; ≥2 consent-driven decisions evidenced.
SEC3		Apply DLP and encryption at-rest/in-transit across platforms and productivity suites	DLP policies enforced; encryption verified; ≥95% sensitive stores covered; exceptions logged with approvals.
SEC4		Audit logging; Cyber Sanctioning Workflow; integrate AI tools governance with SOC for threat monitoring	Audit trail active; sanctioning workflow embedded in intake/change; Purview/metadata telemetry into SOC; detection time reduced ≥20%.
SEC5		Introduce synthetic data in non-prod environments	Policy & generators live; ≥20% non-prod uses synthetic/masked data; compliance check passed.
P1	**Data Platform & FinOps**	Design unified data platform (lakehouse/fabric-style), metadata & interoperability solution, machine-native semantic layer APIs	Medallion reference patterns published; interoperability contracts defined; semantic translation APIs available.
P2		Lakehouse Migration Plan/SoW; complete medallion architecture (bronze/silver/gold) & historic snapshots	SoW approved; ≥3 critical domains migrated; lineage & quality checks embedded; longitudinal reporting enabled.
P3		MortarCAPS common data model ratified and implemented (where appropriate) in integration platform	Ratification memo signed; MortarCAPS entities implemented; variance log maintained; ≥1 domain live on MortarCAPS.
P4		Automation of governance checks (policy-as-code, quality gates, metadata harvesting, access reviews)	≥30% new pipelines auto-validated; exceptions workflow live with SLA; periodic access reviews automated.
P5		Observability baseline & tooling (data freshness, pipeline latency, error rates, SLOs)	Dashboards & alerts live; ≥50% critical pipelines monitored; monthly SLO reports; playbook published.
P6		Structure data for FinOps reporting (tags, allocation, usage telemetry) for data consumption costs	Tagging scheme implemented; FinOps dashboard live; ≥90% workloads tagged; quarterly optimisation actions recorded.

In-Scope Streams (2026/7)

ID	Stream	Work Package	Acceptance Criteria
A1	Analytics	Shared semantic layer with centrally governed KPIs & reusable metrics (tool-agnostic consumption)	KPI catalogue (≥10 KPIs) with owners & definitions; certification workflow live; ≥2 domains consuming; duplicate metrics reduced ≥30%.
A2		Roadmap for executive dashboards aligned to certified semantics	Roadmap approved; backlog prioritised; ≥2 executive dashboards delivered; usage & satisfaction measured.
A3		Decision support processes/tools; advanced analytics tools review & comms	Playbook published; tool list approved; ≥3 decisions traced using certified data; exceptions process documented.
AI1	AI Strategy & AI Operating Model	AI strategy released, AI SoW funded, AI Operating Model & Governance Framework (risk, ethics, lifecycle)	Strategy approved; SoW funded; OM & governance published; model risk taxonomy & review board established; AI backlog prioritised.
AI2		AI playbook; AI pipelines (MLOps registry, monitoring, incident runbooks)	Playbook approved; reference pipelines built; registry live; drift/bias monitoring active; incident runbook tested.
AI3		Platform to record AI use cases for ROI, risks, compliance	Registry live; taxonomy defined; ≥5 use cases registered; quarterly outcomes review; ≥3 remediated/deprecated.
AI4		RAG foundation for enterprise search with governed content	Architecture defined; PoC live with governed sources; access controls enforced; quality evaluation rubric; stakeholder sign-off.
AI5		Expand ML (prediction/anomaly); embed ML with citizen development under guardrails	ML patterns published; ≥2 use cases live; citizen ML guardrails & training; governance checks in place.
AI6		Student fabric pilot/PoC; early warning & intervention models (attrition)	Pilot end-to-end; uses certified semantics; intervention workflow implemented; retention uplift baseline & target defined; monitoring live.
SD1		AI Solution design and potential project to deliver AI storage/training pipelines/controls	Architecture approved; project SoW funded; milestones met; end-to-end tests passed; Handover to Ops documented.

In-Scope Streams (2026/7)

ID	Stream	Work Package	Acceptance Criteria
TR1	**Training & Education**	Training program, tools, content, trainers; calendar; measurement (tool-agnostic)	Program charter; LMS content live; content library; trainer roster; ≥2 courses delivered; ≥60% satisfaction; skills assessments baselined.
TR2		Citizen Data Scientist training (tool-agnostic) on accessing certified/Gold datasets via enterprise catalogues	Hands-on course & labs; ≥70 learners trained; access patterns documented; exercises use certified semantics; post-assessment pass rate ≥70%.
TR3		Train staff on AI risks (shadow AI, prompt injection, data leakage) & safe-use practices	≥30% completion; policy acknowledgments; simulations run; unsafe tool usage incidents reduced ≥10%.
CO1	**Community & Capability**	Working Group established; resource plan & skills uplift; data & AI capability plan	Working Group charter & calendar; capability plan approved; skills pathways; ≥20% domain staff complete foundation; quarterly capability metrics reported.
PR1		IT-led comms & collaboration; roles to liaise/coordinate use cases & data ops; identify local IA deployments	Comms plan executed; roles appointed; shadow AI discovery live; reduction in unmanaged tools ≥30%
R1	**Research Data**	Model unified research data environment (metadata, access, provenance)	Domain model published; access & provenance mapped; governance alignment; ≥1 research dataset onboarded.
H1		Develop & implement HPC/Supercompute strategy (data movement, security, governance integration)	Strategy approved; integration patterns defined; controls tested; initial workloads onboarded; guidance published.
ST1		Assume IRDS for Research; increase non-research storage allocation; storage management processes & residency controls	Allocation plan approved; storage governance processes live; capacity telemetry active; ≥70% compliance to storage policies.

High-Level Schedule

Jan 2026 → July 2027

Quarter 1
Governance

Q1 emphasizes strategy development, governance frameworks, operating model design, and security baselines for foundational setup.

Quarter 2
Platform

Q2 delivers metadata integration, semantic layers, CDE registry, executive dashboard roadmap, and automation for streamlined workflows.

Quarter 3
Observability

Q3 introduces observability, FinOps, AI strategies, AI pipelines, and use case registries to enhance operational intelligence.

Quarter 4
Pilots

Q4 executes pilot projects including RAG foundation, student analytics, research data modeling, and HPC strategies for validation.

Quarter 5
Scaling

Q5 focuses on scaling operations, expanding semantic coverage, migrating datasets, and onboarding new domains for growth.

Quarter 6
Optimization

Q6 optimizes processes, tracks KPIs, and refreshes the roadmap to ensure continuous improvement and strategic alignment.

High-Level Schedule

Q1 (Months 0–3): Foundation & Governance

- G1 – G4: establish governance activities
- OM1: Define the hub and spoke model
- BR1: Develop business requirement templates
- SEC1 – SEC4: cyber security control planning
- P1: design a unified data platform
- TR1, TR3: Create a training program plan
- PR1: establish co-ordination role for communications
- KPII1: develop a dashboard for KPIs

Dependencies: Executive sponsorship (G1), policy approvals (G3), committee setup (G4), architecture oversight (P1), SOC readiness (SEC4)

Quarter 2 (Months 4–6): Metadata, Semantics & Platform Enablement

- P2 – P4: Complete lakehouse migration, MotarCAPs standard and automated governance controls
- A1 – A2: Shared semantic layer and Exec dashboards aligned
- TR2: Citizen data scientist training
- CO1: working group and capability plan
- SEC 5: synthetic data controls
- RAW 1: governance plan for raw vs edited data
- ST1: review research storage allocations

Dependencies: Policies & standards (G3), platform ADRs (P1), Operating Model adoption (OM1), training program live (TR1)

High-Level Schedule

Quarter 3 (Months 7–9): Observability, FinOps & AI Foundations

- P5 – P6: Observability and FinOps for data operations
- AI1 – AI3: AI strategy, op. model, playbook and use case register
- A3: decision support processes
- SEC4: audit logging and threat hunting integration
- BR1: business requirements and AI cases
- DM1: delivery framework refinements for AI

Dependencies: Semantic layer (A1), automation & metadata flows (P4), comms & capability plan (CO1), tracking dashboard (KPI1).

Quarter 4 (Months 10–12): Pilots & Research/HPC Readiness

- AI4 – AI6: RAG foundation for search, expand ML, student fabric PoC
- R1: model unified research data
- SD1: AI solution design for training data and models
- OM2: data operation scaling plan/pilot for domain onboarding

Dependencies: AI OM (AI1), registry & pipelines (AI2–AI3), lakehouse layers (P2), SOC integration (SEC4)

High-Level Schedule

Quarter 5 (Months 13–15): Scale & Operations

- OPS1: Maintain and support model for steady state
- A1: semantic layer with shareable/expanded KPIs
- P2: Lakehouse with additional datasets from consumption
- OM2: scaling domains for spokes across university
- CO1: working group and roles uplift
- A3: analytic tool standards adoption

Dependencies: Observability (P5), FinOps (P6), training completion (TR2/CO1), governance adherence (G2)

Quarter 6 (Months 16–18) — Optimisation & Continuous Improvement

- KPI1: Data performance outcomes and regular reporting
- DM1: delivery framework process improvements and automation
- PR1: learnings communicated and co-ordinated across hub and spoke model
- BR1: use case benefit realization reporting

Dependencies: Stable ops (OPS1), adoption metrics (KPI1), community & capability (CO1)

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Deliverables

ID	Deliverable	Description	Streams
D1	**Data Governance Framework & Operating Model**	Strategy & Roadmap, Framework, Policies, Committees, Hub-and-Spoke OM (Phase 1 & Phase 2).	• G1 – G4 • OM1 – OM2
D2	**Metadata & Semantics**	CDE registry & glossary, semantic layer with certified KPIs, interoperability contracts, machine-native semantic APIs.	• G1 – G4 • A1 – A3
D3	**Platform & Security**	Platform ADRs, lakehouse medallion layers, automation/DataSecOps, observability baseline, FinOps dashboards; classification/RBAC, consent, DLP/encryption, audit logging, cyber	• P1 – P6 • SEC1 – SEC 5 • OPS1
D4	**AI & Analytics**	AI strategy & OM, AI playbook & pipelines, AI use case registry, RAG foundation; student pilot & attrition model MVP; decision support processes; executive dashboards roadmap & deliveries	• A1 – A3 • AI1 – AI6 • P1 – P6
D5	**Training & Adoption**	Training program (tool-agnostic), citizen data training (catalogues & certified data), AI risk education; Working group & capability plan; comms & liaison roles.	• TR1 – TR3 • CO1 • PR1
D6	**Ongoing Operations & Delivery**	Solution design & project SoW (storage/pipelines/controls), ops playbook & resourcing, storage governance (IRDS/non-research), raw/edited governance, tracking dashboard & KPIs.	• DM1 • BR1 • KPI1 • OPS1

Today's Constraints & Dependencies

Data has been identified as a capability with very low maturity, poor governance and management practices.

In implementing the work within this SoW and high-level schedule the following are selected dependencies for a critical path to success:

- G1 → G2/G3/G4: Strategy precedes governance framework, policies, and committees.
- G2/G3 → OM1/DM1/P1: Governance and policy foundations required before operating model adoption, delivery processes, and platform architecture approval.
- P1 → P2/P4/A1: Platform ADRs precede lakehouse migration, automation, and semantic layer deployment.
- A1 → A2/A3/AI6: Certified semantic KPIs needed for executive dashboards, decision support, and student analytics accuracy.
- SEC1–SEC4/SEC5 → AI2/OPS1: Security controls and synthetic data must be in place before scaling AI pipelines and moving to steady operations.
- AI1 → AI2/AI3/AI4/AI6: AI operating model & governance precede pipelines, registry, RAG foundation, and student analytics.
- CO1/TR1/TR2/TR3 → OM2: Training & capability uplift drive successful Phase 2 domain onboarding.
- P5/P6 → OPS1/KPI1: Observability & FinOps enable reliable operations and measurable program KPIs.

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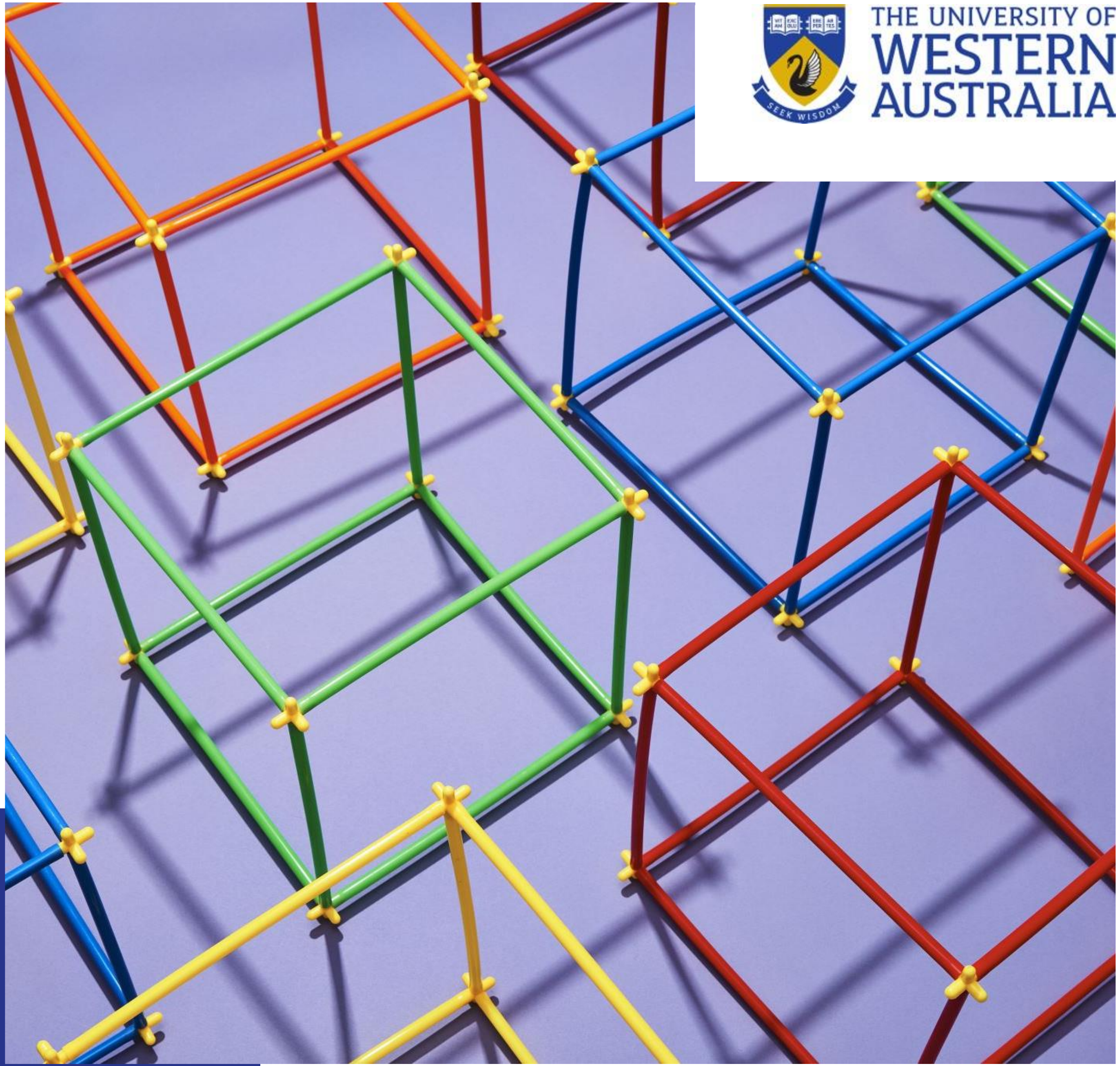
Dependencies

- Executive sponsorship; budget approvals; vendor licensing (Purview, Databricks/Unity Catalog, catalog & lineage tools).
- Access to domain experts (Data Specialists), Research Office, SOC, Legal/Privacy.
- Integration platform readiness (APIs, data lakehouse), network/storage guardrails, device procurement channels.
- Cloud/HPC capacity and partnership agreements (WA/Australia/global).
- Communications channels for training/adoption, service directory, AI access point.



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Tomorrow's Effort (2026/7 estimate)

Executive Sponsor: CIO and Associate Director – Strategy, Architecture & Data

Program Board: Executive sponsor, AD Strategy, Architecture & Data, Portfolio representatives, Senior stakeholders.

Working Group: Stream leads + portfolio liaisons; cadence fortnightly.

Data Office/Hub

- Head of Data/AI (0.5–1.0 FTE) — strategy, executive reporting, operating model ownership.
- Data Governance Lead (1.0 FTE) — framework, policies, committees, adoption.
- Stewardship/Metadata Lead (1.0 FTE) — CDE registry, glossary, catalog integration.
- Data Architect(s) (2.0–3.0 FTE) — platform ADRs, medallion patterns, interoperability contracts.
- Data Engineers (3.0–5.0 FTE) — lakehouse migration, pipelines, automation/DataSecOps.
- Analytics Engineer/Semantic Modeler (1.5–2.0 FTE) — KPI catalogue, semantic layer certification.
- Observability/FinOps Analyst (1.0–1.5 FTE) — monitoring, cost tagging, optimisation dashboards.
- Security & Compliance Specialist (1.0–2.0 FTE) — classification, consent, DLP/encryption, audit logging, SOC integration.
- AI/MLOps Engineer (1.5–2.5 FTE) — AI pipelines, registry, monitoring, RAG foundation.
- Training Program Manager (0.8–1.0 FTE) — training design, delivery, LMS, metrics (tool-agnostic).
- Change & Communications Lead (0.6–0.8 FTE) — comms, champion network, adoption support.
- Data Delivery Manager (1.0–2.0 FTE) — IT Delivery Framework operations, pilot management, retrospectives.

Total Hub Range: ~15–22 FTE
Ramping:
Q1 ~12–15;
Q2–Q4 ~18–22;
Q5–Q6 sustain ~16–20

Doesn't include resources from other IT teams

Tomorrow's Effort (2026/7 estimate)

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Domains (Spokes) – per onboarded domain

- Domain Steward (0.5 FTE) — CDE definitions, quality rules, data decisions.
- Domain Custodian (0.5 FTE) — controls, access, lifecycle.
- Business Analyst (0.5–1.0 FTE) — requirements, case for change, process mapping/mining.
- Analyst/BI Developer (0.8–1.0 FTE) — semantic consumption, dashboards, decision support.
- Citizen Developer cohort — trained through TR2/TR3 (no dedicated FTE, but allocation needed from business units).

Per Domain Range: ~2.3–3.0 FTE during onboarding;
~1.5–2.0 FTE steady state

Security Operations/SOC (Shared)

- SOC Engineer (0.5–1.0 FTE) — telemetry integration, automation runbooks.
- Data Privacy Officer (0.3–0.5 FTE) — consent & privacy controls oversight.
- Platform Security Engineer (0.5–1.0 FTE) — DLP, encryption, RBAC, geo controls.

Shared Security Range: ~1.3–2.5 FTE

Research & HPC

- Research Data Architect (0.5–0.8 FTE) — research data model, IRDS integration.
- HPC Architect/Engineer (0.5–1.0 FTE) — HPC strategy, data movement, controls.

Research/HPC Range: ~1.0–1.8 FTE (Q4–Q6)

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Risks

ID	Risk	Mitigations	Streams
R1	**Role clarity & adoption lag**	RACI in OM1, committee sponsorship in G4, Working group (CO1), comms (PR1).	• OM1, G4, CO1, PR1
R2	**Tooling integration complexity**	Architecture Decision Record - ADRs (P1), phased pilots (AI6), automation (P4), observability baseline (P5)	• P1, P4, P5, AI6
R3	**Security incidents/shadow AI**	AI risk education (TR3), SOC integration (SEC4), discovery tooling (PR1), sanctioning workflow.	• TR3, SEC4, PR1
R4	**Data quality debt**	CDE definitions (implicit in A1/G3), quality rules and assurance reporting (KPI1), semantic certification gates (A1)	• A1, G3, KPI1
R5	**Budget/FTE constraints**	FinOps visibility (P6), business case pipeline (BR1), sequencing per domain maturity (OM2).	• P6, BR1, OM2

Assumptions

ID	Assumption	Implication	Invalidates If…
A1	Executive sponsorship and governance mandates remain active for the full 18 months.	Decisions, funding gates, and prioritisation proceed on cadence; committees can enforce standards.	Sponsor changes or loses mandate; funding delayed; decisions stall.
A2	A single, authoritative Data Governance Framework (aligned to Information Governance) is approved and enforceable.	Policies/standards can be embedded in pipelines and processes; certifications and audits have clear criteria.	Competing frameworks or weak enforcement lead to inconsistent practice.
A3	Domains provide named Stewards and Custodians with time allocation.	CDE definitions, quality rules, and stewardship workflows progress at pace.	Roles not assigned or under-resourced; domain participation drops.
A4	The hub-and-spoke Operating Model (Phase 1) is adopted, with Phase 2 scaling to at least two domains by Month 18.	Clear handoffs, repeatable ways-of-working, and scalable onboarding.	Pilots bypass model; scaling stalls; bespoke processes proliferate.
A5	Unified analytics platform follows medallion/lakehouse patterns with CI/CD governance gates and lineage.	Standardised pipelines; certified Gold datasets drive the semantic layer and dashboards.	ADR not approved; ad-hoc patterns emerge; governance gates bypassed.
A6	Security and privacy controls are mandatory: classification/RBAC, consent, DLP, encryption; synthetic data in non-prod; SOC integration.	Reduced risk; audit readiness; faster incident detection/response.	Controls delayed or exempted; production data appears in non-prod; SOC telemetry incomplete.
A7	CDEs and semantic KPIs are defined and agreed across priority domains (Student, HR/HCM, Finance, Research).	Single source of truth; consistent analytics and AI outcomes.	Cross-domain contention or unclear ownership breaks consistency.
A8	AI Strategy, SoW, and Operating Model are approved; all AI use cases are recorded in the registry and governed.	Scalable AI pipelines (MLOps), portfolio visibility, and risk controls (bias/drift, ethics).	Strategy/SoW delayed; teams bypass registry; "shadow AI" grows.
A9	EDW BAU continuity is maintained during migration; observability and FinOps tagging are feasible across critical workloads.	Reliable service levels, measurable performance/costs, smoother transition.	Dual-run under-resourced; monitoring/tagging coverage insufficient; BAU SLAs missed.
A10	Training is mandatory for Hub and foundational for domains (tool-agnostic), with active comms and a Working Group.	Consistent practices, safer self-service, faster adoption of standards and patterns.	Low attendance/engagement; practices diverge; increased rework and risk.

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Tomorrow's Costs (2026/7)

Cost Category	What's Included	ROM	Not Included
People – Core Hub FTE/Contractors	Strategy, governance, architecture, engineering, analytics/semantic, AI/MLOps, Sec/Compliance, Observability/FinOps, Training, PM/Delivery	**$5.2M – $7.6M**	• Other IT teams • Vendor and licencing • Consultancy fees
Platform & Data Tooling	Data platform (lakehouse/fabric-style), catalog/governance, lineage, data quality, observability, CI/CD, automation/DataSecOps	**$1.2M – $2.2M**	• Other IT teams • Vendor and licencing • SOC fees
Security & Compliance Tooling	DLP/CASB/IRM, encryption/KMS, consent mgmt, SOC integration, threat analytics/automation	**$0.8M – $1.4M**	• Other IT teams • Vendor and licencing • SOC fees • Audits and audit consultants
Storage & Compute (incl. HPC readiness)	Lakehouse object storage, EDW co-existence, non-research capacity uplift, HPC initial enablement	**$0.9M – $1.6M**	• Other IT teams • Vendor and licencing • Compute costs
AI Enablement	AI pipelines & registry, RAG foundation, model monitoring (drift/bias), student attrition MVP (covers the DATA areas)	**$0.7M – $1.3M**	• Other IT teams • Vendor and licencing • Other parts of the AI Strategy SoW
Training & Change	Tool-agnostic training program, LMS/portal, content creation, CoP events, comms	**$0.35M – $0.65M**	• Other IT teams • Vendor and licencing • Tools
Domain Onboarding (Phase 2)	Onboarding 2 domains: BA, stewards/custodians enablement, tailored WoW, dashboards	**$0.4M – $0.8M**	• Other IT teams • Vendor and licencing
Contingency (10–15%)	Integration complexity, migration surprises, security/residency controls	**$1.0M – $1.8M**	• Other IT teams • Vendor and licencing • Other IT work needed
TOTAL ROM (est.)	18 months	**$10.55M – $17.35M**	

Tomorrow's Costs

Cost Dependencies

- Staffing mix (perm vs contractor rates), time-to-hire.
- Tooling choices (enterprise governance platform, observability suite, consent management);
- Licensing models (consumption vs per-user).
- Security posture (breadth of DLP/CASB, geo-residency enforcement, SOC automation depth).
- Scope of AI pilots (RAG reach, number of models in production).
- Storage growth (historical snapshots, research vs non-research allocation).
- Number and maturity of domains onboarded in Phase 2.EDW coexistence complexity (dual-run duration).
- Training volume and custom content depth.

Doesn't include:

- Costs forecasting
- Demand
- Vendor & market cost changes.

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Process to develop the SoW

1. Attend meetings related to data or capture data related opportunities (audit, DataOps, strategies)
2. Collate all the responses – Miro, Excel
3. Develop SOW pack
4. Draw up activities, gaps and what's needed
5. Identify common themes
6. Use co-pilot to crunch all the 250+ data statements from business and IT
7. Develop SoW streams of work
8. Use co-pilot to identify dependencies, risks, assumptions, roles, costs
9. Check content and edit changes
10. Use co-pilot to summarise for Exec summary
11. Check content and make relevant changes

Using co-pilot to process and analyse hundreds of future state data & AI statements has saved paying for 2 junior Consultants at approx. $1000 a day for 4 weeks - $40,0000